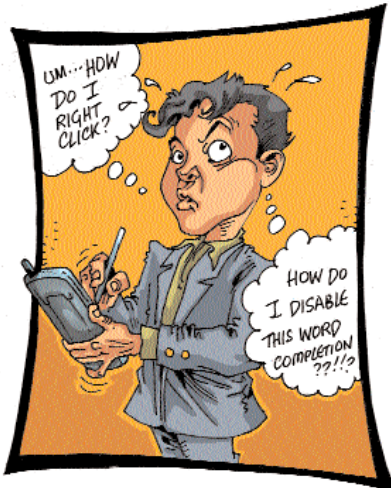


WINDOWS MOBILE



Windows Mobile is what all smart phone or PocketPC users use. Being a Microsoft product, users are on familiar territory. There are differences, though, when it comes to connecting wirelessly or syncing with desktop PCs. There are certain limitations that can be overcome by changing a few settings here and there.

Here are some tips to help optimise the way you use your device.

Change Views In IE

Having a compact portable device gives you a lot of flexibility, but they aren't without the handicaps. A small screen means you scroll horizontally a lot more because of the way pages are designed.

Internet Explorer has a single-column view that can be enabled by going to Menu > View > One Column. You can also choose to view Web pages in full-screen mode by clicking on Menu > View > Full Screen.

No Right-click?

Most newcomers to the mobile smart device spaces may be wondering how you right click with a stylus. It's easy; the trick is to tap the screen and not let go.

Set Wallpapers

Wallpapers help lighten up your computing environment—Pocket PCs and smartphones are no different. Go to Start > Pictures & Videos (or any location where images are stored). Open the image, click on Menu, and then on "Set as Today's Background".

Fix For FAT16 File Length

File lengths can be a problem in FAT16 and folders like My Documents cannot be displayed. The only fix is to use Windows to create the file name.

Use Transcriber And Hardware Keyboard

People can be confused by the types of recognisers. When typing long messages, its best to use the transcriber rather than the letter recogniser. Similarly, the hardware keyboard is better than using the soft keyboard on-screen. To switch to the transcriber, click the arrow next to the recogniser button; click on transcriber.

Switch Time To Digital

The clock in Windows Mobile can be switched between digital and analogue. To switch between the two modes, keep the stylus pressed on the time in the taskbar and you will be prompted with a choice between a digital and analogue clock.

Disable Word Completion

Word completion is enabled by default in Windows Mobile. Every time a user starts entering a word, Windows Mobile suggests the complete version. This can be a little irritating at times when you want to enter words which aren't in the dictionary. You can disable word completion by going to Start > Settings > Input > Word Completion. Uncheck the checkbox "Suggest words when entering text" to disable word completion. You can also alter other settings such as the timing of the word completion.

Disable Unnecessary Connections

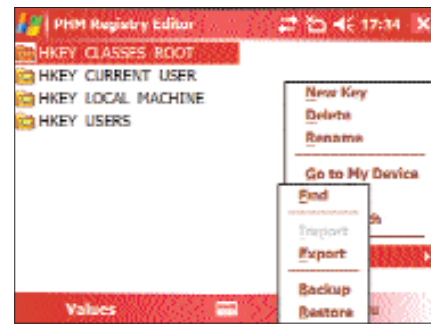
As it is, portable devices are short on power. Using wireless connections means you'll be running short on power in no time. It is then important to disable wireless connections whenever they aren't required. To do this, start the Comm Manager by tapping its icon when on the Desktop. Disable Bluetooth and Wi-Fi by clicking their respective icons. Disabling vibration should also help conserve your batteries.

Control The Registry From Windows

When your mobile device is connected to a PC, you can use one of the many registry editors on your desktop. Mobile Registry Editor (www.breaksoft.com/Blog/Utilities/2005/1/Mobile_Registry_Editor.aspx) is a good example.

If you want a Registry editor that runs on the device itself, you can use PHM Registry Editor (www.phm.lu/Products/PocketPC/RegEdit). We'll be needing Registry editors for the next set of tips. (Note: Create a backup of your registry and proceed with caution!)

To create a backup using PHM Registry Editor, select Menu > Tools >

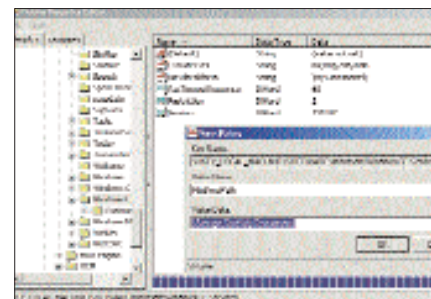


Back up your Registry!

Backup. Enter a location and the backup will be saved. We used Mobile Registry Editor to make changes to the Registry on the mobile device through the hardware link.

Change Location Of My Documents

By default, the My Documents folder is located on the onboard memory of your device, which cannot be removed. So the only way to access those documents is to use a cable and connect it to your Desktop. You can change the location at which your My Documents is stored to



Change the path of the My Documents folder

an external storage card. Browse to the key HKEY_LOCAL_MACHINE > Software > Microsoft > Windows CE Services. Create a key FileSyncPath value to \Storage Card\My Documents or any other location of your choice. Remember to create a folder on the storage card with the name "My Documents".

Change The IE Cache Location

Similar to changing the location of your My Documents folder location to a storage card, the contents of the Internet Explorer cache can be stored on the same card. This can give you extra space for the cache. To modify this setting you need to go to HKEY_CURRENT_USER > Software > Microsoft > Windows > CurrentVersion > Explorer > ShellFolders. Alter the values of

\Windows\Profiles\Guest\History
 \Windows\Profiles\Guest\Cookies
 \Windows\Profiles\Guest\Temporary Internet Files